

Interdependence and Conservation

Nature stays in balance through interdependence — and human actions can disturb or protect it.

Everything is connected

Living things depend on non-living things and on each other for **nutrition, respiration and reproduction**. Disturbing one part affects the whole habitat — this is **interdependence**.

- Plants make food using sunlight, air, water and soil; animals depend on plants and other animals.
- Removing one species (e.g. overfishing) can change the numbers of many others — a ripple effect.

Humans and habitats

Cutting forests for roads and buildings, and changes in rainfall and temperature, **shrink animals' habitats**. Losing their home, animals like **elephants wander into farms and villages**, causing conflict.

Wildlife corridors: ecologists mark **corridors** that connect forest patches, letting elephants and other animals move safely between forests without entering human settlements.

Take-away: protecting habitats and their balance protects all the life (including us) that depends on them.

Where students lose marks

Trap 1 — Removing one species affects many. Food and pollination links mean a single change ripples through the habitat.

Trap 2 — Human-wildlife conflict comes from habitat loss. Elephants enter farms because their forest food/water is gone, not "by nature".

Trap 3 — A corridor connects habitats. It allows safe animal movement, reducing conflict — it is not a road for humans.

Model answers — write them like this

Example A. Why do elephants sometimes enter farms and villages?

Step 1: Forests shrink due to tree-cutting and changes in rainfall/temperature.

Step 2: With food and water scarce in their habitat, elephants search nearby farms.

∴ Habitat loss pushes elephants into human areas.

Example B. How do wildlife corridors reduce human-elephant conflict?

Step 1: Corridors connect separate forest areas.

Step 2: Animals can move between forests safely without crossing villages.

∴ They give animals a safe path, reducing conflict.

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